

Superintendent Pay in Context DRAFT

Andover, CT · Dr. Valerie Bruneau and her Connecticut peers · FY 2025–26

A personal report by Scott Sauyet · scott@sauyet.com · Not an official town document

Data was assembled by crawling 45 small Connecticut town and school district websites, OCR'ing scanned PDF contracts, and manually reviewing contracts shared as Google Drive links. Of the 45 peer districts identified as comparable to Andover, 21 districts (16 unique superintendent contracts) have contract data in hand; for the remaining 23 a thorough search of public sites did not locate a contract, or the contract on disk is awaiting review. All figures are “cash compensation” — the salary line plus any board-paid 403(b) annuity, longevity bonus, fixed transportation allowance, and other lump sums. Health insurance value, life insurance face amount, long-term disability, sick-day buyback, and IRS-rate mileage reimbursements are excluded. Because Connecticut superintendent contracts vary widely in work effort — from 16-hour-per-week part-time positions to full-time K-12 regional superintendents — all dollar figures are normalized to a hypothetical 1.0-FTE-equivalent (260-day work year) for apples-to-apples comparison. Andover's portion of Dr. Bruneau's compensation is reported separately so readers can see both what Andover pays and what her market-rate compensation works out to.

INTRODUCTION

Overview

Dr. Valerie Bruneau is Andover's Superintendent of Schools. She is also Scotland's, under a separate contract not yet in hand. Her time is split 60/40 between the two K-6 districts — 0.6 FTE at Andover and 0.4 FTE at Scotland. Andover's contract pays her \$90,000 cash plus a \$10,000 mandatory 403(b) deferral for the 2025–26 school year, for an Andover-paid total of \$100,000. Treating that as the Andover-share of a single full-time job, her implied 1.0-FTE-equivalent compensation is **\$166,667**.

This report sets that figure in context by comparing it to every other Connecticut superintendent contract we could find for the 45 small towns identified as peers — towns of similar size, similar grade-level structure, and similar regional profile. The contracts vary in age and scope, so the report presents three different cuts of the data, each with different inclusion rules. Andover sits near the bottom in all three.

A note on methodology before the numbers

Two methodological choices shape every table that follows. Both deserve a line of explanation before the numbers appear.

FTE-equivalent, not raw salary. Andover is a small K-6 district that shares its superintendent with Scotland. Other towns in the peer set are also small enough to share — Region 4 (Chester, Deep River, Essex/Centerbrook) has one K-12 superintendent across four boards; ER9 (Easton, Redding, Region 9) has one across three. Comparing Andover’s \$100,000 Andover-paid amount to Region 4’s per-town share isn’t apples-to-apples because Andover is paying for 60% of a person’s time while Region 4 districts are each paying for 25% of a different person’s time. The FTE-equivalent normalization expresses each contract as “what would this superintendent earn if working a full 260-day work year at this district’s pay rate.” It is the metric that makes contracts comparable across different sharing arrangements.

By contract, not by district. When three boards sign one joint contract (McKinnon for ER9; White for Region 4), it is one observation, not three. The tables in this report dedupe by contract for joint cases (one row for McKinnon, listing Easton/Redding; one for White, listing Centerbrook/Chester/Deep River). Where two districts share a superintendent under *separate* contracts, each is counted as its own observation when we have both. Bruneau’s Andover and Scotland contracts are an example: she appears here under Andover, and would appear again under Scotland once that contract is obtained.

ANDOVER'S CONTRACT

Part 1 — Dr. Bruneau’s contract

The current Andover contract runs from July 1, 2023 through June 30, 2026. Section 2 explicitly defines the role as a 0.60 FTE position. Section 4 defines “annual base salary” as the sum of (a) a cash component paid biweekly and (b) a \$10,000 mandatory deferral into a 403(b) annuity. The three contract-year figures are:

Andover’s portion of Dr. Bruneau’s compensation ✓ *Confirmed from contract, Section 4*

Contract year	Cash component	403(b) deferral	Andover-paid total
2023–24	\$80,000	\$10,000	\$90,000
2024–25	\$85,000	\$10,000	\$95,000
2025–26	\$90,000	\$10,000	\$100,000

Notes: Source: [Andover Superintendent Contract 2023-2026](https://www.andoverelementaryctforms/2023-2026_Superintendents_Contract.pdf) (https://www.andoverelementaryctforms/2023-2026_Superintendents_Contract.pdf), Section 4 (BASE SALARY). The 403(b) amount is technically a “salary reduction agreement” — the Superintendent elects to defer \$10,000 of her base salary into a tax-sheltered annuity — but it is part of the total compensation the Board is obligated to provide, and the Board reports the full \$90K+\$10K total to the Connecticut State Teachers’ Retirement System.

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What “\$166,667” includes. The comparison tables in Part 3 sum, for every contract, the same cash items: the salary cash component plus the board-paid or board-provided 403(b) annuity plus any longevity bonus plus any fixed transportation allowance. For Bruneau in 2025–26 that is \$90,000 cash + \$10,000 annuity = \$100,000 — both lines included, not just the salary cash. Divided by Andover’s 0.6 FTE share gives the 1.0-FTE-equivalent rate of \$166,667 used in every comparison below. Health insurance value, life insurance face amount, long-term disability, sick-day buyback, and IRS-rate mileage reimbursements are *not* included for any contract — see the Methodology italic at the top of the report. The treatment is uniform: if a peer contract has its own annuity, it is added in the same way.

The 2026–2029 successor contract — referenced in the FY26/FY27 town budget approved February 11, 2026 — proposes a \$100,000 cash component for FY 2026–27, plus a \$15,000 annuity (up from \$10,000). Part 4 returns to that figure and shows where it would land in the current peer distribution.

PEER COHORT

Part 2 — The peer cohort

The original peer list contained 45 small Connecticut towns selected for similarity to Andover (small enrollment, small budget, K-6 or K-8 elementary structure, sometimes regional secondary). After excluding Norwich (which is structurally very different — much larger, much more urban), the working comparison set is 44 districts.

Of those 44, contract data is available for 16 unique superintendent contracts covering 21 districts. The remaining 23 districts split into three groups:

- **21 districts** — including Scotland, where Bruneau is the other half of the shared role — where a thorough search of the town and school district websites did not locate a superintendent contract online. CGS § 10-244c (Public Act 17-2) directs town clerks to post these contracts on the town website, but compliance is uneven. Requesting a copy from the town clerk — including via the state’s Freedom of Information process — is one possible mechanism for obtaining a missing contract.
- **4 districts** have a contract PDF on disk that has not yet been manually reviewed (Chaplin, Columbia, Falls Village, Winsted). All four are pre-2024 and would likely contribute stale data even after review.

- For four districts in particular (Bethany, Marlborough, Storrs/Mansfield, Woodbridge) board meeting minutes specifically reference the superintendent contract, but a thorough search of both **DRAFT** and the school district websites did not locate the document itself.

The full list of pending districts appears in Sources at the end.

COMPARISON

Part 3 — Three views of the comparison

The same underlying data supports three different views, each with different inclusion rules. Each makes a slightly different argument; the picture changes from view to view but Andover's position never improves.

View 1 — All contracts we can find, latest known

The most inclusive view. Includes every contract whose dollar figure we have a real observation for, regardless of when it was signed. Six contracts in this view are stale (data is from 2021–22 or 2023–24 because no newer contract was located), and one — the LePage Region 7 contract — covers an HS-only role rather than K-6/K-8. Stale rows are flagged with △.

Andover ranks **13th of 16**. Mean: \$199,257. Median: \$195,000.

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Rank	Superintendent	Year	District(s)	FTE-equiv
1	Dr. Jason McKinnon	2025–26	Easton, Redding	\$310,408
2	Dr. Frank Olah	2021–22 [△]	Hampton	\$246,340
3	Brian White	2021–22 [△]	Centerbrook, Chester, Deep River	\$244,378
4	Dr. Thomas Baird	2025–26	Hebron	\$223,736
5	Immacolata Canelli	2024–25	East Hartland	\$208,880
6	Scott Feder	2025–26	Voluntown	\$200,000
7	James C. Agostine	2025–26	Barkhamsted	\$196,920
8	Steven LePage [†]	2023–24 [△]	New Hartford	\$195,000
9	Dr. Jack Zamar	2025–26	Bozrah	\$193,063
10	Michele Raynor	2025–26	Brooklyn	\$185,000
11	Dr. Roy Seitsinger	2025–26	Preston	\$179,307
12	Mary Beth Iacobelli	2024–25	Norfolk	\$173,750
13	Valerie Bruneau	2025–26	Andover	\$166,667
14	Philip “Phil” Stevens	2023–24 [△]	West Willington	\$164,591
15	Steven Rioux	2021–22 [△]	Canterbury	\$153,200
16	Donna P. Leake	2021–22 [△]	Eastford	\$146,866

Notes: [△] flags contracts whose dollar figure is from before 2024–25. [†] Steven LePage’s Region 7 contract covers high-school-only (grades 7–12), a meaningfully different role from the elementary-only superintendents that dominate this list. The three contracts ranked below Andover are all stale and likely understate current rates after multi-year step-ups; Stevens’ West Willington contract, also stale, sits just below.

View 2 — K-6 / K-8 only, latest known

Filters out the three K-12 regional superintendent contracts (McKinnon ER9, White Region 4) and the HS-only Region 7 contract (LePage), leaving only contracts whose scope is comparable to Andover’s K-6 role. This is the cohort that most directly matches Dr. Bruneau’s role.

Andover ranks **10th of 13**. Mean: \$187,563. Median: \$185,000. Andover is **–10% below the median** (\$166,667 vs \$185,000).

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Rank	Superintendent	Year	District(s)	FTE-equiv
1	Dr. Frank Olah	2021–22 △	Hampton	\$246,340
2	Dr. Thomas Baird	2025–26	Hebron	\$223,736
3	Immacolata Canelli	2024–25	East Hartland	\$208,880
4	Scott Feder	2025–26	Voluntown	\$200,000
5	James C. Agostine	2025–26	Barkhamsted	\$196,920
6	Dr. Jack Zamar	2025–26	Bozrah	\$193,063
7	Michele Raynor	2025–26	Brooklyn	\$185,000
8	Dr. Roy Seitsinger	2025–26	Preston	\$179,307
9	Mary Beth Iacobelli	2024–25	Norfolk	\$173,750
10	Valerie Bruneau	2025–26	Andover	\$166,667
11	Philip “Phil” Stevens	2023–24 △	West Willington	\$164,591
12	Steven Rioux	2021–22 △	Canterbury	\$153,200
13	Donna P. Leake	2021–22 △	Eastford	\$146,866

Notes: Filter: --latest-known --scope k-6,k-8 . The three contracts ranked below Andover (Stevens, Rioux, Leake) are all stale; Rioux’s Canterbury contract expired June 2023 and Leake’s Eastford contract expired June 2024, so the current Canterbury and Eastford rates are almost certainly higher than the stale figures shown. Stevens’ West Willington contract is still running through June 2026 but the listed figure is year-1 (2023–24); years 2 and 3 likely include step-ups.

View 3 — K-6 / K-8 only, current contracts only (strict)

The most apples-to-apples view: K-6/K-8 scope, contract data from 2024–25 or later, no stale figures. This eliminates uncertainty about whether older contracts have been renegotiated since.

Andover ranks **9th of 9** — last. Mean: \$191,925. Median: \$193,063. Andover is **–14% below the median**.

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Rank	Superintendent	Year	District(s)	FTE-equiv
1	Dr. Thomas Baird	2025–26	Hebron	\$223,736
2	Immacolata Canelli	2024–25	East Hartland	\$208,880
3	Scott Feder	2025–26	Voluntown	\$200,000
4	James C. Agostine	2025–26	Barkhamsted	\$196,920
5	Dr. Jack Zamar	2025–26	Bozrah	\$193,063
6	Michele Raynor	2025–26	Brooklyn	\$185,000
7	Dr. Roy Seitsinger	2025–26	Preston	\$179,307
8	Mary Beth Iacobelli	2024–25	Norfolk	\$173,750
9	Valerie Bruneau	2025–26	Andover	\$166,667

Notes: Filter: --scope k-6,k-8 (the default strict rule). **No K-6/K-8 peer with a current contract pays less than Andover.** The next-lowest peer — Norfolk at \$173,750 — pays 4% more than Andover does. Scotland is not in this table because Bruneau’s Scotland contract has not yet been obtained; when it is, the expected entry would tie Andover at \$166,667.

FY 2026–27

Part 4 — The FY 2026–27 proposal

The 2023–2026 Andover contract expires June 30, 2026. The successor contract — referenced in the FY26/ FY27 town budget approved February 11, 2026 — bumps the cash component from \$90,000 to \$100,000 for FY 2026–27 (a +11.1% increase on the cash component) and bumps the 403(b) deferral from \$10,000 to \$15,000.

The combined effect: Andover’s payment goes from \$100,000 to \$115,000 (+15%). At the same 0.6 FTE share, the implied 1.0-FTE-equivalent rate goes from \$166,667 to \$191,667.

Where the FY27 proposal would place Andover against current peer rates

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Rank	Superintendent	Year	District(s)	FTE-equiv
1	Dr. Thomas Baird	2025–26	Hebron	\$223,736
2	Immacolata Canelli	2024–25	East Hartland	\$208,880
3	Scott Feder	2025–26	Voluntown	\$200,000
4	James C. Agostine	2025–26	Barkhamsted	\$196,920
5	Dr. Jack Zamar	2025–26	Bozrah	\$193,063
—	Andover (FY 2026–27 proposed)	2026–27	Andover	\$191,667
6	Michele Raynor	2025–26	Brooklyn	\$185,000
7	Dr. Roy Seitsinger	2025–26	Preston	\$179,307
8	Mary Beth Iacobelli	2024–25	Norfolk	\$173,750
9	Valerie Bruneau	2025–26	Andover (current FY26)	\$166,667

Notes: This is an apples-to-not-quite-apples comparison. The Andover row is FY 2026–27. The peer rows are mostly FY 2025–26. Almost all of those peer contracts will themselves step up in FY 2026–27 — and Andover’s relative position will move down again once those FY27 peer figures are negotiated and published. So this table is best read as “where the FY27 Andover number would sit *if peer pay froze*”, which it won’t. The FY27 row is interpolated between Bozrah (\$193,063) and Brooklyn (\$185,000) under that “frozen peer” assumption. The +\$10K cash bump that has drawn public attention reflects a contractual move from –14% below the current-cohort median to roughly –1% below it, in a cohort that itself will likely move up before FY27 begins. The 403(b) annuity bump from \$10K to \$15K — less remarked upon — is a structural change worth noting separately.

The successor contract has not yet been published in full as of this report’s compilation date. When it is, the FY28 and FY29 figures (cash components of \$105K and \$110K respectively, per the budget document, plus the \$15K annuity) can be added.

Summary table

Question	Answer
What does Andover pay Dr. Bruneau for FY 2025–26?	\$90,000 cash + \$10,000 403(b) = \$100,000 total
What's the 1.0-FTE-equivalent rate that implies?	\$166,667 (Andover's share is 60% of a full-time position)
Where does that rank against peer Connecticut superintendents?	Bottom 4 of 16 in the broadest view; last of 9 in the strictest
How far below the K-6/K-8 peer median is Andover?	\$18,333 (–10%) below the latest-known median of \$185,000; \$26,396 (–14%) below the strict median of \$193,063
Does any K-6/K-8 peer with a 2024-or-newer contract pay less?	No. Andover is the bottom of every current-data peer cohort.
What would FY 2026–27 do to Andover's ranking against current peer rates?	Move from last among 9 to roughly the middle of the pack ($\approx 1\%$ below current median). Peer rates will themselves rise in FY27, so the actual FY27-vs-FY27 picture will likely shift back toward the current gap.
What is "cash compensation" in this report?	Base salary + board-contributed 403(b) + longevity bonuses + fixed transportation allowances
What's excluded?	Health insurance value, life insurance face amount, LTD, IRS-rate mileage, sick-day buyback

ANALYSIS

Key Observations

Andover's superintendent rate is unambiguously below peer rates across every cut of the data we can run. The bottom-of-the-distribution finding is not an artifact of one inclusion rule. Whether you use the broadest view (every contract we can find, including stale ones, all scopes) or the strictest (K-6/K-8 only, no stale data), Andover sits at or near the bottom.

The strict K-6/K-8 view is the cleanest comparison. It eliminates two confounders — scope mismatch (K-12 regional supes earn more because their role is bigger) and stale data (older contracts almost certainly have step-ups not visible from the dollar figures we have). In that view, Andover is rank 9 of 9 — last — and no K-6/K-8 peer with a current contract pays less than Andover does.

The three contracts ranked below Andover in the broader views are likely understated. Canterbury (Rioux, \$153,200) is from a 2020–2023 contract that expired three years ago; the current Canterbury is presumably higher after intervening step-ups. Same logic applies to Eastford (Leake) and West Willington (Stevens). If those updated figures came in higher than today's listed numbers, Andover would sit lower still in the broader views.

The FY 2026–27 proposal would move Andover from rank 9/9 to roughly rank 6/9 in the strict view against current peer rates — and that's the important qualifier. The peer contracts shown are mostly FY 2025–26. Most of them will themselves step up in FY 2026–27. So while Andover's FY27 number would substantially close the gap if peer pay stood still, peer pay won't stand still, and the actual FY27-vs-FY27 picture will likely shift back toward the current gap. The +\$10K cash bump moves Andover closer to the current-cohort median; whether it moves Andover closer to the FY27 median is a different question that this report can't yet answer.

The 403(b) bump from \$10K to \$15K is a structural change worth noting separately. The cash-component bump from \$90K → \$100K is what the FY26/FY27 budget document spotlights, but the 403(b) component is going up by half (50%) at the same time. Both are tax-advantaged compensation to the supe; both raise Andover's total cost.

Twenty-three peer districts are not in this analysis. A thorough search of public sites did not locate a current contract for 21 of them; four more have a contract PDF on disk that has not been manually reviewed. Adding those would change the median, but in which direction is hard to predict — the missing districts skew toward very small, very rural Connecticut towns where part-time superintendent arrangements are common, and whether their part-time rates would land above or below Andover's FTE-equivalent is genuinely unknown.

CAVEATS

What this report does not show

- **Total compensation** including health insurance value, life insurance face amount, long-term disability, sick-day buyback, and IRS-rate mileage. These items vary widely across districts and a fair comparison would require valuing each district's specific health plan; the cash-only comparison sidesteps that.
- **Years of experience or tenure.** A first-year superintendent at \$200,000 is a different observation from a 20-year veteran at \$200,000. This report treats every contract uniformly regardless of the superintendent's experience.
- **Cost of living adjustments.** Fairfield County districts (Easton, Redding) have higher local costs than the eastern Connecticut towns that dominate the lower end of this distribution. The FTE-equivalent figures are nominal, not cost-of-living-adjusted.

- **Per-pupil or per-budget normalization.** A larger district legitimately needs a more senior superintendent, and some peers manage two or three times Andover's enrollment. This report normalizes by FTE, not by enrollment or budget size.
- **The missing peers.** The 21 districts where a thorough search did not locate a current contract, plus the four with PDFs on disk awaiting review, may have rates above or below the current cohort.
- **A causal claim about appropriateness.** This report describes where Andover sits in the peer distribution. It does not argue that being below median is good or bad, or that any particular pay rate is the "right" one. That is a judgment for residents.

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DOCUMENTATION

Sources

Andover-specific documents

- **Andover Superintendent Contract 2023-2026** — [andoverelementaryct.org/.../2023-2026_Superintendents_Contract.pdf](https://www.andoverelementaryct.org/images/forms/2023-2026_Superintendents_Contract.pdf) (https://www.andoverelementaryct.org/images/forms/2023-2026_Superintendents_Contract.pdf) (scanned PDF, OCR'd)
- **Andover FY26/FY27 Town Budget** — approved at the February 11, 2026 Town Meeting; provides FY27 proposed figures

Peer-district contracts in the analysis (16)

In FTE-equivalent rank order:

- McKinnon (ER9: Easton, Redding) — direct PDF, 2024-2027
- Olah (Hampton) — direct PDF, 2021-2022 [A](#)
- White (Region 4: Centerbrook, Chester, Deep River) — [essexct.gov/.../contract_-_supt_-_white_b_2021-24_signedpdf-PDF](https://www.essexct.gov/DocumentCenter/View/362/contract_-_supt_-_white_b_2021-24_signedpdf-PDF) (https://www.essexct.gov/DocumentCenter/View/362/contract_-_supt_-_white_b_2021-24_signedpdf-PDF), 2021-2024 [A](#)
- Baird (Hebron) — [hebron.k12.ct.us/.../GetFile.ashx](https://www.hebron.k12.ct.us/common/pages/GetFile.ashx?key=2CGfAbjf) (<https://www.hebron.k12.ct.us/common/pages/GetFile.ashx?key=2CGfAbjf>), 2025-2028
- Canelli (East Hartland / Hartland) — crawled, 2024-2027
- Feder (Voluntown) — [voluntown.gov/.../Superintendent-PDF](https://www.voluntown.gov/DocumentCenter/View/489/Superintendent-PDF) (<https://www.voluntown.gov/DocumentCenter/View/489/Superintendent-PDF>), 2025-2026
- Agostine (Barkhamsted) — crawled, 2023-2026 (FY26 estimated from year-1 + teacher-scale increases)

- LePage (New Hartford, Region 7 HS-only) — [newhartfordct.gov/.../reg_7_superintendents_contract_2023-2026.pdf](https://www.newhartfordct.gov/sites/g/files/vyhlf81661/files/reg_7_superintendents_contract_2023-2026.pdf) (https://www.newhartfordct.gov/sites/g/files/vyhlf81661/files/reg_7_superintendents_contract_2023-2026.pdf) [△](#)
- Zamary (Bozrah) — Google Drive copy supplied by district, 2025-2028
- Raynor (Brooklyn) — crawled, 2024-2027
- Seitsinger (Preston) — crawled, 2025-2028
- Iacobelli (Norfolk) — crawled, 2022-2025 (year-3 figure used)
- Bruneau (Andover) — Andover scanned PDF OCR'd, 2023-2026
- Stevens (West Willington) — crawled, 2023-2026 [△](#)
- Rioux (Canterbury) — Canterbury CMS [media/3811](https://www.canterburyct.org/media/3811) (https://www.canterburyct.org/media/3811), 2020-2023 [△](#)
- Leake (Eastford) — [eastfordct.org/.../Superintendent-Contract-2022.pdf](https://www.eastfordct.org/wp-content/uploads/2023/06/Superintendent-Contract-2022.pdf) (https://www.eastfordct.org/wp-content/uploads/2023/06/Superintendent-Contract-2022.pdf), 2021-2024 [△](#)

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Pending — contract not located in public search (21)

A thorough search of the town and school district websites did not locate a superintendent contract for these districts; one possible mechanism for obtaining a missing contract is a request to the town clerk under the state's Freedom of Information process.

Ashford, Baltic, Bethany, Colebrook, Kent, Lakeville (Salisbury), Marlborough, New Hartford (K-6, separate from Region 7), North Canaan, North Franklin (Franklin), Pomfret Center, Salem, **Scotland** (Bruneau's other contract), Sharon, Sherman, Sterling, Storrs (Mansfield), Union, West Cornwall (Cornwall), Woodbridge, Woodstock.

Pending review — PDF on disk, not yet manually verified

Chaplin, Columbia, Falls Village, Winsted.

Excluded

Norwich (too dissimilar in size and structure to be a useful peer).

Statutory basis

- CT Public Act 17-2 § 157 / CGS § 10-244c (requirement to post superintendent contracts on town websites)

Methodology and tooling

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The full data pipeline, including the web scraper, OCR pipeline, comparison script, and `compensation.json` data file lives in a separate working repository. The corrections log inside that data file documents seven instances where automated attribution was wrong and was corrected during OCR — including the largest, which was that an early Region 1 contract attribution was actually a New Canaan contract incorrectly hosted under a `"/canaan"` CMS subdomain.

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